

Our Vision

- Local People's participation
- Their empowerment in decision making
- People's control Over resources

In order to find solutions to environmental degradation.



NEWSLETTER

MAY 2009

Our Mission

Janhit Foundation envisions to work towards a pollution free world where every individual can have a healthy existence and promotes sustainable development in every sphere. Through its local and national initiatives Janhit Foundation links up to global initiatives and believes in creating positive global impacts.

Janhit Foundation is an independent, not-for-profit non-governmental organization, actively engaged in the promotion of human welfare through environmental protection since 1998.

Key areas of work include:

- Groundwater quality protection for human health
- Provision of safe drinking water to marginalized communities
- Protection of river water quality for aquatic ecosystems
- Enhancement of available water resources through water conservation measures
- Promotion of sustainable agriculture by organic farming methods
- Environmental education and empowerment of local communities

Janhit Foundation undertakes this work through scientific research, campaigns, advocacy and grass-root level community involvement.

As a public interest organisation, Janhit Foundation focuses on strengthening local communities through their active participation in decision making, to achieve sustainable development. We believe that environmental degradation can only be addressed adequately if local people are empowered in decision making at all levels and have control over resources.

To achieve our goals, we work in partnership with government, non-governmental, national and international organisations on environment and human rights issues.



Geographical Scope of The Organisation

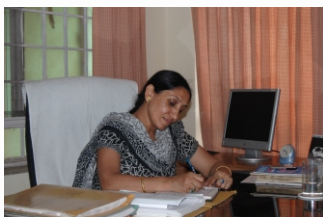
Uttar Pradesh



The Janhit Foundation is working in the Indo-Gangetic alluvial fed states of India, i.e. in Western Uttar Pradesh, Punjab and Haryana. Its Area of focus in Uttar Pradesh is primarily Meerut, Baghpat, Ghaziabad and Muzaffarnagar.

- From the Director's Desk

I wish Janhit Foundation could be a platform through which we can provide a clean and green environment to the community. An environment which is free of pollution, let it be air, water or land.



Beneficiaries at Various Stages

Since its establishment the organisation has been able to make a difference to many a lives...

- Farmers by motivating them to practice organic farming which is proving to be a better farming practice, bringing economic and general prosperity in their lives.
- Students by providing them guidance with their PHDs, research papers, exchange programs, internships and also through information dissemination and awareness.
- Teachers and Lecturers through presentations, documentary film shows, lectures and discussions given in a number of schools, colleges, universities and research institutes.

- Researchers by providing them data and other material relevant to their studies, practical trainings etc.

Also scientists, government departments, various stakeholders, other NGOs, national and international organisations and even the common people have been influenced by us in more than one way.

As a public interest organisation, Janhit Foundation works with the marginalized communities, women and minorities. It is the belief of the organisation that environmental degradation can only be addressed adequately if local people are empowered in decision making at all levels and have control over resources.

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Jaibheem Nagar : Results Awaited.... - Nipun Kaushik

This year 2009, is witnessing elections to the House of Commons, with the contesting parties finding several issues to present before the masses through their election manifestoes, amongst them the issue of Safe Water supply is one of the most pertinent. It is important to note that it has already been well realized at the national front that the Right to safe and clean drinking water has to be safeguarded. Thus the national attention is not a surprise.

A 'Clean Water Commission' which is being highly advocated in different states of United States also needs to find place in the Indian policy making scenario. With reference to the situation in India and in particular Western Uttar Pradesh, here water was available in such abundance that its scarcity could have never been imagined. But the present situation poses such a threat that the future generations will surely have doubts on the history posing this region as one of the most water abundant *doab* region.

It is a matter of serious concern when blatant violation of Right to Safe Drinking Water is happening at the hands of the Government authorities in here even after it being guaranteed by the Supreme Court of India under Article

21 of the Indian Constitution through B.L. Wadhwa v. Union of India¹. Such has been happening in the Meerut District of Western Uttar Pradesh in the slum colony of Jaibheem Nagar. This locality has found continuous space in the publications of Janhit Foundation and even local and national media but their wait for clean and safe drinking water doesn't seem to end.

Initially when Janhit Foundation took up this issue long back in 2005-06, the

residents of this locality were facing a situation which was not only worthy pity but was certainly sad. There was no provision of safe drinking water in the locality. The colony is included in the municipal limits of the

Meerut City but the treatment that has been meted out to it makes one believe that perhaps it's not a part of the city. The residents have had to travel a minimum distance of 3-4 Km to clean drinking water as the only source of water are the hand pumps that give out contaminated water. This water does not qualify the basic characteristics of potable water. Thus the water which was not even worth looking at and the residents were supposed to consume it without any complaints. The water has been contaminated due to two surface



water sources lying besides the colony on each side. One being the Kali River, a tributary of River Hindon, which carries large amount of untreated waste of industries flowing into the river. On the other side is a pond which is actually an artificial pond created by the waste of the Lala Lajpat Rai Medical College, Meerut. The regular seepage has caused the contamination of ground water to such levels that it's worth not usage.

Janhit Foundation in past has very successfully performed the role of a pressure group holding the Government authorities responsible through making the organizations like Food First Information and Action Network (International) aware of the situation and also informing the Prime Minister's Office and Chief Minister's Office (CMO) of Uttar Pradesh.

Subsequently, due to the orders from CMO, the work of making provision of clean and safe drinking water had been initiated long back in 2006. Several Interventions by Janhit Foundation such as writing to FIAN, or writing to the District Authorities have led to issue of 100 public connections, however their installations are still awaited.

Even in March 2009, the water supply connections have still not been installed though all provisions prior to distributing connections have been made. The plight of the inhabitants of the Jaibheem Nagar has taken a new face in the form of corruption of the government officials incharge of distributing connections. Thus Janhit Foundation again took note of the situation in March-April 2009 and wrote letters to all concerned authorities informing them about the irregularities regarding the issue. As already

indicated, 100 public connections have also been promised to the residents of the locality as most of the families inhabiting the colony belong to the marginalized group of the society and thus can't afford to have a independent connection for themselves. These public connections were stated to be the first priorities but unfortunately none of them have yet been installed.



It's a pity that even in the 21st century or after 60 years of Independence, the country has not been able to ensure protection of a basic right of the citizens of the country. The worst is that even after regular pressure created through all means, the government officials still show a lethargic attitude towards the same. We need to rise, inform ourselves on this issue, and have an increase in the public participation at levels of policy and decision making at the government so that such incidences are a rare possibility in one of the largest democracy of the world.

UN Charter 1948

Universal Declaration for Human Right

Article 25

'Right to Water'
Still Struggling
For
Safe Drinking Water

¹ AIR 1996 SC 314

Highlights of Last Few Months

Establishment of the Processing Units

A very innovative project was initiated by Janhit Foundation last year in April. It aimed at ending the monopolistic cultivation of Sugarcane and paddy crops. The new crops introduced to the farmers herein were Lemongrass, Citronella and Neem. Thus came the revival of the medicinal and aromatic cultivation at a large scale. At the initiation, a nursery was set up with approximately 1000 saplings of Neem, 2 lakh saplings of Lemongrass and a lakh of Citronella. January 2009 witnessed a new step within this project undertaken by Janhit Foundation towards its aim of providing better agricultural opportunities and enhancing the agricultural income of the farmers of this region.

A processing unit was set up in village Atrada for extracting the oil of lemongrass and also a distillation unit for the raw material of Neem plant. With this the oil and extracts of these crops can be processed at the village level itself and now the farmers do not have to depend on the any external source for the same. This has certainly helped making the farmer self dependent and it made available better income provisions for them.



Since the processing is being carried out at the village level so farmers are realising the gains achieve and moreover now the farmer is supplying the final product and not the raw material so he is procuring a better income out of it.

The expulsion of Oil at the farmers level eliminates the need of the middle men, providing the farmer to extract fair prices and its encouraging to know that more and more farmers are being motivated.

Celebrating the World Water Day, 22nd March 2009

One of the basic aims of Janhit Foundation which it strives to achieve is the community participation. To raise community participation, Janhit Foundation organized a seminar in Dewan Institute of Technical Studies, Meerut with over 100 students pursuing their technical education who were benefited as audience.

Dr. D Chakroborty, Senior Scientist, Central Ground Water Board enlightened the audience by delivering a lecture on Water Management and Governance.



The students also participated actively by making him face certain realities of India by posing questions to him. Mrs. Anita Rana, Director Janhit Foundation delivered the keynote address and motivated the students to save every drop of water. Further Ms. Arshinder Kaur, Janhit Foundation gave an interactive presentation on the



importance of the World Water Day. The students took an oath to save and conserve water in every possible means.

Raising the Environmental Debate, 20th April 2009

The long lasting debate of Economics and Environment went into junior students of different schools when Janhit Foundation organized an Inter School English Debating Competition in Godwin Public School, Meerut. The participation of 8 schools with 26 students was encouraging. The debate session was so interesting and rather the audience was left thunderstruck with small kids arguing over matters pertaining to economics, environment, carbon emission, market regulations etc.



Contributing to the pursuit of education

Bhavy Sharma, a child of 14 years had been pushed to sudden poverty by the fateful accident under the Delhi Uphar Case in 1997 in which he lost both his parents Late Mr. Madan Sharma and Late Mrs. Vipin Sharma. They both went to Delhi to buy gifts for Bhavy's birthday but destiny held something different in its kitty. It left Bhavy orphaned with his 80 year old grandmother who has been taking care of the daily expenses of the household by selling the commodities of the house. It has been sad that some unsocial elements of the society want to capture the small property holdings, Bhavy and his grandmother holds. These people have even attempted abduction of Bhavy to secure the property and whatever little money they have.

The compensations which were promised by the government have not made its way to their home. He is studying in Darshan Academy, Meerut and has to join school in Class IX in the academic session 2009-10. The school management has been kind enough to render him free education. But in this time of extreme inflation even books is a burden on such a fateful family. Thus Janhit Foundation through the CHILDLINE has bought all the books required for the coming academic calendar. This has amounted to Rs. 1730/-. Bhavy and his grandmother have been sincerely thankful for this contribution of Janhit Foundation in the education of the child.

Facilitating and Encouraging Education amongst the Marginalized Children, January 25th 2009

93rd Amendment to the Indian Constitution brought in Article 21 A which guarantees education to all children below the age of 14. However, several hundred thousand children in India are still deprived of primary education. With the aim of bringing awareness amongst all, Janhit Foundation conducted a quiz competition on general awareness exclusively for the marginalized children of Meerut. The competition aimed at encouraging such marginalized children who are already going to school; motivating those who have not joined school yet; judging the awareness level of these children, and rewarding the talent and knowledge of these marginalized children.

61 children participated in the competition. The children were provided with the necessary stationary items. They were required to solve hundred multiple-choice questions in one hour. After the competition got over, they were told the correct answers. Following that, the Janhit team



distributed sweets among the children. Thereafter the Janhit team taught the participants about



CHILDLINE (a 24-hours toll-free emergency service run by Janhit Foundation for the children) and Republic Day in detail. Towards the end, the children expressed their innate talent in the form of song, dance and other cultural activities. The winners were also given prizes which would surely work as encouragement for them and for all.

Training Sessions on Organic Farming

Janhit Foundation aspires to bring a large number of farmers under the fold of organic farming. For the promotion of organic farming methods, field experts of the Janhit Foundation conduct periodic and regular training sessions with the farmers. These training sessions inform the farmers about various aspects of organic farming. Continuous trainings and visits by the Janhit team members enables the farmers build their confidence and practice methods of Organic farming. Beginning January 2009 until April 2009, Janhit Foundation has organized five training courses in Meerut villages.



Bhanera Khemchand- A Concern for All

Janhit Foundation while conducting the study of the Hindon River and its tributaries in the past came across a village, Bhanera

Khemchand which is the worst hit of the industrial pollution. Located on the catchment of River Krishna, a tributary to Hindon inhabits approximately 2400 people and it is pertinent to note that the village is a home to numerous gastrointestinal water borne diseases and many lung related diseases and almost half of the population has been ill.

On April 27, 2009, Janhit Foundation served as a facilitator for the Global Inventory Project Training Program of Blacksmith Institute, New Delhi for the above mentioned site. A field visit was organized for a team from the Institution comprising of 12 members from different parts of the world. The team was led by Ms. Promila Sharma, Program Director, Blacksmith Institute, New Delhi. The team took note of the basic details regarding the agricultural practices, the changes in the life



patterns of the villagers since the river has been connected to the industrial untreated or semi-treated waste.



Ben Stradwick, a citizen of United Kingdom is working as a volunteer with the organization since March 9, 2009 and has made considerable contribution in various activities being undertaken by the organization. He has introduced a professional concept of program management, including the concept of Gantt Charts to the Janhit Foundation.

The newsletter welcomes your suggestions, observations and comments. For further details write to janhitfoundation@gmail.com

The Janhit Family

Anita Rana took over as the Director from July, 2009

After the untimely and sudden passing away of Lt. Sh. Anil Rana, the organization is now running smooth in the capable hands of Ms. Rana.

Janhit Team

Anita Rana	Director
Ashinder Kaur	Honorary Advisor
Sandhya Verma	Administration Incharge
Sonakshi Hudda	P R Manager
Nipun Kaushik	Documentation Officer
Devpal Singh	Sr. Programme Coordinator
Shiv Kumar	Sr. Programme Coordinator
Sunil Yadav	Programme Coordinator
Bhupinder	Programme Coordinator
Rohit Kumar	Programme Assistant
Ravindra Kumar	Programme Assistant
Ravindra Kumar Saini	Programme Assistant
Deshraj	Programme Assistant
Jitendra Kumar	Programme Assistant
Santosh Hudda	Organic Aaharam Manager

Arshinder Kaur joined the organization as the Honorary Advisor

Ms. Kaur has twelve years of national and international experience in natural resource management and eco & agricultural governance. The organizational management takes her inputs for all important decisions.

CHILDLINE Team

Sanjiv Kumar	Coordinator	Manmohan Singh	Team Member
Asha Rani	Para-Professional	Pramod Kumar	Team Member
Atul Kumar	Team Member	Anil Kumar	Team Member
Jyoti	Team Member	Kavita Sharma	Volunteer
Mamta	Team Member	Romalisa Agnihotri	Volunteer
Satyendra Kumar	Team Member	Nazli Naseem	Volunteer

Voices From Around

Prince Kumar, Winner, GK Quiz Competition
I am so excited to receive this bicycle as the first prize, its like a dream come true. Thank you Janhit for organizing the quiz for children from my locality.

Vinay Tyagi, Farmer, Village Attrada- Beneficiary of Processing Unit
Janhit Foundation through this innovative project gave us an opportunity to deviate from the monoculture practice in agriculture growing of sugarcane and paddy. When lemongrass oil was extracted from the distillation unit and sold in the market, I was overwhelmed to realize the sudden and considerable enhancement in my income.

Dr. Rahul Bansal, Prof & Head, Community Medicine Department, Subharti Medical College
It was certainly an honour and pleasure to be a part of the jury for the Debate Competition. It is pertinent to note the increasing amount of awareness among the children of the present generation who presented their views on a sincere topic like Carbon Emission. It was a tough job judging the participants as all of them were better than the other.

Shilpi Bansal, In-charge, Eco Club, Dewan Institute of Technology
It was a different and nice experience celebrating World Water Day with a Seminar. All the attendees were enlightened on various issues related to water and felt satisfied after being replied to their queries by Senior Scientist Dr. Chakraborty.

Satyapal Singh, Village Head Man, Bhanera Khemchand
I am glad that the problem of my village has been noted at the Blacksmith Institution through Janhit Foundation. The manner in which the village have been inspected and villagers being interrogated, we the villagers carry high hopes that a solution to our problem is nearing us.

Bhavya Sharma
I am thankful to Janhit Foundation for helping me financially and enable me buy books for the next academic session. My heartfelt thanks to the Janhit family and I am encouraged to work hard academically by their kind endeavor.